



Why our home is The Castle

“Home is where the heart is”. “There’s no place like home”. “Take me home country roads”.

We’ve all thought it. Or said it. Sung it even, if you’re John Denver. There’s a reason why often the first thing we ask someone when we meet them is “where’s home for you?”

Psychologists say that for many, our home is part of how we define ourselves, which is why we do things like decorate the living room and mow the lawn. While a leopard print futon serves very little real purpose, it’s still part of the face we put on, with our homes viewed as an extension of ourselves.

And now more than ever, life revolves around home. For months, it’s been the backdrop for everything we do: Zoom calls, workouts, failed bread attempts and some impressive - if sometimes a little wonky - DIY fix its.

We’ve taken shelter from the rest of the world, experiencing moments of happiness, sadness and at times a touch of insanity.

We stopped wearing pants. Neglected personal grooming. Ate anywhere between six and ten meals a day. All the while in the comfort of our own home.

But enough about what we did during lockdown. Let’s talk about home. And why exactly, according to the much loved characters from The Castle, it’s so important to us.

It’s not a house. It’s a home.

Let’s get the basics out of the way. We have a roof over our head and some sturdy walls to surround and protect us. We have doors, windows. Shutters and blinds.

BUT - what we actually have is so much more. Home is a place to call our own and to make memories in. Pictures and photos adorn the walls, telling stories of the years gone by.

Ultimately, humans have evolved to become not only home builders but homemakers, and most importantly, home-nesters.

Costs less than the materials.

Much like the characters in The Castle, this one we’re not too sure about. However, we know a fair bit about construction materials and building products, and what can we say? Building your own home from scratch is so rewarding that perhaps it makes the cost of the materials just seem less?

And sure, this includes the bricks and mortar. But it also includes the décor designed to reflect your very own unique taste. Want every wall to be a different colour? Why not. A floor to ceiling fish tank? Add it to the list. It’s your home, after all.

Tell him he’s dreamin.

Owning your own place doesn’t have to be a dream. And compared to renting, you have the ultimate freedom. Everyone’s invited - can’t live without your dog? Cat? Snake? Bring them along, we’re not judging.

This is an opportunity to create something of your own, where anything and everything that is important to you has a place.

What do you call this? Chicken, love.

We all come together over a meal at home to mark the end of a long day. Whether it’s chicken or faux chicken that you’re munching on, you’re swapping war stories from the day gone by, sharing in the highs and lows.

For better or worse, the places where we grow up play a huge role in our identity. Day after day, home is where we discover ourselves and form a sense of belonging, occasions marked with special meals - be it christmas dinners or birthday brunches.

This is going straight to the pool room.

Home is a place to be unashamedly proud of our achievements. While we might accept recognition in the outside world with a shy smile and an imperceptible nod, at home we’re jumping on the bed in our undies clutching our prize, which will eventually be hung up in all its glory in the pool room.

And during covid - who knew? We’d achieve something just by staying inside. Owning your own home means that you can drill a hole in the wall to hang every single award of yours, no matter how big or small.

How’s the serenity? So much serenity.

When we’re at home, we’re completely at ease. We can be ourselves, and truly soak up the serenity that comes with the familiarity of home, the people, the pets, and all the things around us. Home is our shelter from the outside world, our sanctuary. For a few precious moments, we can make time stop still if we really want it to.

He’s an ideas man.

During Covid, we had to become the ideas man. We got creative, and our home became the place where we held meetings, fermented various things and knitted our seventh scarf, though we’d never knitted before. No idea is a bad idea, and in the comfort of our own home, anything is possible.

Dad reckons fishing is 10% brains, 95% muscle, and the rest is just good luck.

Look - this has nothing to do with owning a house, but it was just too good a quote not to include. We suppose you could say that building a house is 10% the idea, 95% the muscle, and when done properly, you don’t even need the good luck!

So, as the original holiday makers of Bonny Doon would say...“in summing up”:

Our home is our castle because it is a space that reflects us. It’s the best possible place to gather, shelter and escape from a busy world. It’s where we can simply just be.

And of course...“it’s the culture. The place is full of culture.”